

Archaeology in India grew into a more serious undertaking in the late nineteenth century. The ASI was set up in 1861 to survey and document India's ancient monuments. It oversees archaeological research and the preservation of monuments across the country.

Preserving the past for the future

Over the years, Thapar gained a stellar reputation both at home and abroad. His work helped expand what was then known about ancient India, but his impact does not end there. He was a founder member of the Indian National Trust for Art and Cultural Heritage (INTACH) in 1984. INTACH is a non-governmental organization that undertakes the preservation of monuments that fall outside the ASI's purview. It works to spread awareness of the importance of heritage, and involves the general public in conserving monuments. It also collaborates with both government and international agencies to protect sites of historical and cultural significance.